

Independent Contractor Agreement

This Independent Contractor Agreement ("Agreement") is by and between Rapport IT Services inc ("Rapport"), of 300 Delaware Ave, STE 210, Wilmington, DE 19801 and Srikanth Goud Padala ("Contractor"), of 10275 Falling Leaf DR NW Concord, NC 28027-8139

Description of Services. The Contractor, working independently and not as an employee of the Rapport, agrees to provide the following services (collectively, "Services"):

The Contractor will provide **Senior Qualys Vulnerability Management Engineer** services to the assigned end client (Toyota) of the Rapport, including roles and responsibilities but not limited:

Qualys Platform Ownership

- Serve as the primary Qualys platform owner and subject matter expert for the OT Cybersecurity program.
- Administer, configure, and optimize Qualys VMDR environments including Cloud Agents, scanner appliances, scan profiles, asset grouping, and API-driven automation.
- Experience with Python, PowerShell, or Bash for API-driven automation.
- Leverage TruRisk scoring, EPSS, CISA KEV, and Real-Time Threat Indicators for risk-based vulnerability prioritization.
- Troubleshoot complex scanning issues and continuously evaluate new Qualys features and modules for adoption.

ServiceNow Integration Support

- Support and help optimize the Qualys–ServiceNow Vulnerability Response integration, ensuring accurate data flow, CI matching, and synchronized asset inventory.
- Collaborate with ServiceNow administrators on automated workflows, vulnerability orchestration, and data quality monitoring.

Vulnerability Analysis and Remediation

- Analyze scan results, validate findings, assess exploitability, and determine remediation priorities based on risk and operational impact.
- Partner with OT, IT, engineering, and plant operations teams to coordinate and track remediation efforts.
- Support alignment of vulnerability data across complementary tools including Tanium and Microsoft Defender.

Continuous Improvement and Security Posture Advancement

- Proactively identify gaps and inefficiencies in vulnerability management processes and propose measurable improvements.
- Establish and track metrics including mean time to detect, mean time to remediate, scan coverage, and TruRisk trends to demonstrate measurable progress.
- Advocate for security improvements through data-driven recommendations to leadership.
- Stay current on emerging threats, Qualys platform updates, and OT cybersecurity trends.

Reporting and Knowledge Sharing

- Build dashboards and reports to communicate vulnerability status, risk posture, and remediation progress to stakeholders.
- Maintain documentation of platform configurations, scan coverage, remediation workflows, and exceptions.
- Support internal and external audits.
- Mentor and train team members on Qualys best practices and vulnerability management workflows.

The Contractor shall deliver services professionally and meet project goals and quality standards. This role is work from onsite/hybrid at client (Toyota) location Greensboro, NC.

Performance of Services. The Contractor is a professional who will perform the Services using tasks assigned by the end client of the Rapport and equipment provided by the end client. The Contractor will determine their own business methods to complete the assigned tasks and will not receive training from the Rapport or the end client on how to perform the Services. The Services may be carried out at times and locations deemed appropriate by the Contractor, unless otherwise specified by the end client. Except where the Contractor operates within a territory defined by the end client, their Services remain independent from the core operations of the Rapport's or end client's business. The Contractor will ensure that all

Services comply with applicable federal, state, and local laws and regulations, and will maintain any necessary licenses, permits, and registrations required to perform the Services.

Term. This Agreement will begin on April 27th, 2026, and will remain in effect for **1 year** ("Termination Date"), unless terminated earlier as specified in the Termination section. If the end client of the Rapport extends the project, this Agreement may be extended accordingly. Either party may also modify the Termination Date by mutual written consent.

Termination. Either party may end this Agreement prior to the Termination Date, with or without cause, upon 2 weeks days' written notice to the other party ("Early Termination"). Upon Early Termination, the Contractor shall receive a pro-rated payment for the Services rendered prior to the Early Termination Date.

Payment for Services. The Rapport will pay compensation to the Contractor for the Services
Payments will be made as follows:

\$72 per hour, with payment processed on a monthly invoice basis and Net 60 payment terms. Invoices will be paid upon submission of a client-approved timesheet.

Expenses. No other fees or expenses, except those outlined in the Payment for Services section above, will be paid to the Contractor unless such fees or expenses have been approved in advance by the Rapport in writing. The Contractor's business and travel expenses are to be paid by the Contractor and not by the Rapport. The Contractor shall be solely responsible for all taxes, Social Security contributions or payments, disability insurance, unemployment taxes, and other payroll type taxes applicable to such compensation.

Relationship of Parties. It is understood by the parties that the Contractor is an independent contractor with respect to the Rapport and not an employee of the Rapport or the end client of the Rapport. The Rapport will not provide fringe benefits, including health insurance benefits, paid vacation, or any other employee benefit, for the benefit of the Contractor.

An "employer-employee" or "principal-agent" relationship is not created merely because (1) the Rapport or the end client of the Rapport has or retains the right to supervise or inspect the work as it progresses to ensure compliance with the terms of the Agreement or (2) the Rapport or the end client of the Rapport has or retains the right to stop work done improperly. The Contractor has no right to act as an agent for the Rapport or the end client of the Rapport and must notify any involved parties that it is not an agent of either.

It is contemplated that the relationship between the Contractor and the Rapport shall be non-exclusive. The Contractor also performs services for other organizations and/or individuals. The Rapport has no right to inquire further about the Contractor's other activities.

Rapport's Control. The Rapport and the end client of the Rapport have no right or power to control or otherwise interfere with the Contractor's mode of effecting performance under this Agreement. The Rapport's only concern is the result of the Contractor's work, and not the means of accomplishing it. Except in extraordinary circumstances and when necessary, the Contractor shall perform the Services without direct supervision by the Rapport or the end client of the Rapport.

Assignment. The Contractor agrees that the Contractor will not assign, sell, transfer, delegate, or otherwise dispose of any rights or obligations under this Agreement without the prior written consent of the Rapport. Any purported assignment, transfer, or delegation made without prior written consent shall be null and void. Written consent is necessary to safeguard the Rapport's confidential information. If an assignment is approved, the new party must sign agreements to protect and maintain confidentiality.

Development of Intellectual Property. Any designs, plans, reports, specifications, drawings, inventions, processes, and other information or items ("Intellectual Property") produced by the Contractor while performing the Services under this Agreement will be assigned to the Rapport. The Contractor shall sign all documents necessary to perfect the rights of the Rapport in such Intellectual Property, including the filing and/or prosecution of any applications for copyrights or patents. Upon request, the Contractor shall sign all documents necessary to assign the rights to such Intellectual Property to the Rapport. The parties deem the compensation described in this Agreement to be valid consideration for those assignments, whether or not patentable. In the event any Intellectual Property shall be deemed by the Rapport to be patentable or otherwise registrable, the Contractor shall assist in completing any required application or registration.

Confidentiality. The Contractor may have had access to proprietary, private, and/or otherwise confidential information ("Confidential Information") of the Rapport or the end client of the Rapport. Confidential Information shall mean all non-public information that constitutes, relates, or refers to the operation of the business of the Rapport or the end client of the

Rapport, including without limitation, all financial, investment, operational, personnel, sales, marketing, managerial, and statistical information, and any and all trade secrets, customer lists, or pricing information. The Contractor will not at any time or in any manner, directly or indirectly, use for their personal benefit, or divulge, disclose, or communicate in any manner any Confidential Information. The Contractor will protect such information and treat the Confidential Information as strictly confidential. This provision shall continue to be effective after the termination of this Agreement. Upon termination of this Agreement, the Contractor will return to the Rapport all Confidential Information, whether physical or electronic, and other items used, created, or controlled by the Contractor during the term of this Agreement.

This Agreement is in compliance with the Defend Trade Secrets Act and provides civil or criminal immunity to any individual for the disclosure of trade secrets: (i) made in confidence to a federal, state, or local government official, or to an attorney when the disclosure is to report suspected violations of the law; or (ii) in a complaint or other document filed in a lawsuit if made under seal.

Insurance. The Contractor acknowledges their obligation to obtain appropriate insurance coverage for themselves and for their employees, if any. The Contractor waives any rights to recovery from the Rapport or the end client of the Rapport for any injuries that the Contractor or their employees may sustain while performing the Services under this Agreement and that are a result of the negligence of the Contractor or their employees. The Contractor will provide the Rapport with a certificate naming the Rapport and the end client of the Rapport as additional insured parties.

Indemnification. The Contractor agrees to indemnify and hold the Rapport and the end client of the Rapport harmless from all claims, losses, expenses, fees, including attorney fees, costs, and judgments that may be asserted against the Rapport or the end client of the Rapport that result from the acts or omissions of the Contractor, employees, agents, and representatives.

Entire Agreement. This Agreement contains the entire agreement of the parties with respect to the subject matter contained herein. No other promises, warranties, representations, agreements, or understandings, whether oral or written, exist concerning this subject matter. This Agreement supersedes any previous or simultaneous oral or written promises, warranties, representations, agreements, or conditions between the parties.

Waiver. The failure of either party to enforce any provision of this Agreement shall not be construed as a waiver or limitation of that party's right to subsequently enforce and compel strict compliance with every provision of this Agreement.

Severability. If any provision of this Agreement shall be held to be invalid, illegal, or unenforceable for any reason, the remaining provisions shall continue to be valid and enforceable. If a court finds that any provision of this Agreement is invalid, illegal, or unenforceable, but that by limiting such provision it would become valid and enforceable, then such provision shall be deemed to be written, construed, and enforced as so limited.

Applicable Law. This Agreement shall be governed by the laws of Delaware.

Signatories. This Agreement shall be signed by Rapport IT Services Inc and by Srikanth Goud Padala. This Agreement is effective as of the date first above written.

For Rapport:

Signed by:

BE88248EE2604BE...
Name: Divya Priya Karumuchi Sekar
Title: Executive VP
Date: 4/27/2026

For Contractor:

Signed by:

A5F3E952AA20494...
Name: Srikanth Goud Padala
Date: 4/27/2026